

Seif Abdelgawad

Junior Network Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Junior Network Security Engineer with hands-on lab and trainee experience across **Palo Alto Networks, FortiGate, and Sophos XG** firewalls using PNETLab and VMware environments. Skilled in firewall policies, security zones, NAT, routing, App-ID/application control, IPS validation, VPN fundamentals, traffic-log analysis, and structured network troubleshooting. Completed industry certifications and hands-on cybersecurity training, with practical exposure to penetration testing through TCM Security and PortSwigger labs. Currently pursuing **OSCP**. Seeking a junior Network Security, Firewall Support, or SOC/NOC Security role.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

2020 – 2024

Faculty of Computer and Information Systems – Computer Science Department

Grade: **Very Good**

EXPERIENCE

Trainee – Network & Security Engineering

2026 – Present

21CK-IT

- Assisted in configuring and maintaining network infrastructure across **3+ network segments**, including routing, switching, and firewall policies.
- Supported firewall administration and security monitoring tasks under senior engineer guidance, contributing to **10+ configuration and policy review cycles**.
- Gained hands-on exposure to enterprise network security operations including VPNs, access control, and traffic analysis across a multi-zone network environment.

Network Security Lab Trainee – Firewall Administration

2026

Hands-on Security Labs – PNETLab

- Configured and troubleshooted **3 enterprise firewall platforms** (Palo Alto, FortiGate, Sophos XG) across **10+ lab scenarios**, covering security zones, policies, NAT, routing, and traffic-log analysis.
- Implemented and validated application-aware security controls using Palo Alto **App-ID**, successfully controlling and categorizing **15+ application traffic types**.
- Configured firewall rules and NAT policies, then analyzed traffic logs to resolve **20+ connectivity and security-policy mismatches**.
- Built and tested **4+ segmented network topologies** to validate zone-based traffic flows between internal, external, and protected network zones.
- Practiced cross-platform troubleshooting across policy matches, routing, NAT translations, and security logs.

Cybersecurity Trainee – Self-Directed Cybersecurity Labs

2022 – Present

- Solved **50+ hands-on labs** on TryHackMe and Hack The Box, focusing on reconnaissance, exploitation, and privilege escalation.
- Completed **100+ practical labs** on PortSwigger Burp Suite Academy covering OWASP Top 10 vulnerability classes.
- Performed web application testing covering **5+ vulnerability categories** including authentication flaws, input validation issues, and misconfigurations.
- Documented **10+ vulnerability reports** with detailed attack paths and actionable remediation recommendations.
- Gained exposure to Palo Alto Networks centralized firewall management (**Panorama**) and cloud security posture management (**Prisma Cloud**).

CERTIFICATIONS

• Palo Alto Networks Certified Network Security Professional (PCNSP) – Palo Alto Networks	Jul 2026
• ET80 – Sophos Firewall Engineer v22.0 – Sophos	Aug 2026
• ET15 – Sophos Endpoint Engineer v6.0 – Sophos	Sept 2026
• Fortinet NSE 4 – FortiGate Security – Fortinet	In Progress
• Fortinet NSE 2 – Network Security Associate – Fortinet	Aug 2026
• Fortinet NSE 1 – Information Security Awareness – Fortinet	Aug 2026
• CCNA: Introduction to Networks – Cisco	Jun 2026
• OSCP – Offensive Security Certified Professional – Offensive Security	In Progress
• Linux 100: Fundamentals – TCM Security – Heath Adams	Completed
• Practical Ethical Hacking – The Complete Course – TCM Security	Completed
• Practical Web Application Security and Testing – TCM Security	Completed
• Web Application Penetration Testing & Bug Bounty – Level 1 – Cyber3rb, Ahmed Qaramany	Completed

PROJECTS

IPS Detection & Prevention Lab – Sophos XG Firewall2026

VMware | Sophos XG Firewall | Parrot OS | Windows Server | Nmap | Metasploit

- Designed and deployed a **2-zone segmented VMware lab** (LAN + DataCenter) with Sophos XG Firewall inline to inspect and control all inter-zone traffic.
- Configured an IPS policy bound to the LAN → DataCenter firewall rule and validated it through **3 controlled attack simulations** in an isolated environment.
- Achieved a **100% attack blocking rate after IPS enablement**; traffic passed when IPS was disabled and was fully blocked after activation, confirmed through firewall logs.

Sophos XG DoS Protection – TCP SYN Flood Test2026

Sophos XG | VMware | hping3

- Simulated a **TCP SYN Flood** attack against Sophos XG in an isolated VMware lab using **hping3**, generating high-volume flood traffic.
- Validated before/after detection behavior: attack traffic passed without DoS protection and **100% of flood packets were blocked** after enabling the policy.
- Reviewed firewall security logs to confirm full detection and mitigation, producing a structured before/after analysis report.

Palo Alto Firewall Security Policy Migration Project2026

Palo Alto Networks | PAN-OS | App-ID | SSL/TLS Decryption

- Migrated **15+ security rules** from legacy port-based policies to modern application-based policies using Palo Alto App-ID, improving traffic visibility and policy precision.
- Configured and reviewed App-ID application identification and SSL/TLS decryption concepts across **2 decryption policy types** (inbound and outbound).
- Identified **3+ bypass techniques** targeting network security controls and documented corresponding mitigation approaches.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Firewall & Network Security

- Palo Alto Networks:** NGFW, Security Policies, NAT, Routing, App-ID, User-ID, Content-ID, Antivirus, Anti-Spyware, Vulnerability Protection, URL Filtering, WildFire, GlobalProtect, Panorama, Prisma, Site-to-Site IPsec VPN.
- FortiGate & Sophos XG:** Firewall configuration, security policies, NAT, routing, network segmentation, traffic monitoring, and log analysis.
- Networking:** TCP/IP, routing, switching, security zones, traffic analysis, VPNs, access control, VMware virtual environments.

Offensive Security

- Security Concepts:** OWASP Top 10, vulnerability assessment, authentication vulnerabilities, input validation, security misconfigurations, basic threat modeling, Active Directory.
- Tools & Platforms:** Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, hping3, Linux, Windows, VMware, TryHackMe, Hack The Box, PortSwigger Academy.

Professional Competencies

- Documentation:** Vulnerability reports, attack paths, remediation recommendations, security findings.
- Analytical Skills:** Network troubleshooting, root-cause analysis, traffic-log analysis, security issue investigation.

LANGUAGES

Arabic: NativeEnglish: Fluent